WEBINAR COMPANION · 6 NOVEMBER 2026

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Five ways to make your repository easier for AI to use

These five steps can make a public repository easier for AI to use. They are not a guarantee of better answers, and you do not have to launch new services.

Keep public information easy to reach, and keep protected information protected

Reachable. Decide what should be easy for anyone to see and what should stay behind the protections you use. Restricted data should stay protected, while public descriptive records can remain open without a special login.

Simple check: Ask someone who is not signed in to open a public page, and confirm that a restricted data download still requires the intended authorization.

Describe your collections clearly, including their limits

Readable. Say what a collection covers, who it is for, and what it cannot tell someone. A visitor should not have to guess the scope from a title alone.

Simple check: Show a public record page to a colleague new to it and ask them to say what the data are about and what they leave out.

Explain how people already find, request, and download data

Callable. Write down how people already search, request access, and download, so people and AI can follow them. If you already offer a way for software to retrieve data, document it too. You do not need a new service.

Simple check: Follow your own instructions as if you had never visited the site, and note the first place a newcomer would get stuck.

Give each record a stable identity, context, credit, and reuse rules

Meaningful. Make it easy to tell what a record is, who created it, how to credit them, and whether others may reuse the work. Keep those facts in a predictable place.

Simple check: On one public record, find the name, who should be credited, and what reuse is allowed.

Try real questions and check the answers against sources you trust

Evaluation. Pick questions your users actually ask. See what an AI tool answers, then compare those answers with your own pages. Do not paste private or controlled information into outside tools.

Simple check: Write down three questions, the answer you received, and the page that confirms or corrects each one.

Full checklist · Webinar